

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS ON THE 22/7 PESO REAL-TIME GROSS SETTLEMENT OPERATIONS

A. BACKGROUND

1. What is the 22/7 Peso Real-Time Gross Settlement (RTGS) Operations?

The 22/7 Peso RTGS Operations is an initiative of the Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas (BSP) to extend the operating hours of the Peso RTGS system from the current 8.75 hours a day, 5 business days a week, to 22 hours a day, 7 days a week, except on nationwide regular and special non-working holidays.

2. Why is BSP implementing the 22/7 Peso RTGS Operations?

This initiative supports: (a) the BSP's mandate to maintain a safe, efficient, and reliable payment system; (b) the G-20 goal of enhancing cross-border payments; and (c) the seamless flow of funds domestically and internationally to facilitate the conduct of economic activities.

3. When is the target implementation date?

The target soft launch is scheduled for November 2026.

4. Will all participants be required to fully implement the 22/7 Peso RTGS Operations by the soft launch date?

No. BSP does not expect all participants to be fully onboard by the soft launch in November 2026. Participation is expected to increase progressively following the soft launch.

B. BUSINESS DAYS AND SETTLEMENT WINDOWS

5. What are the settlement windows under the 22/7 Peso RTGS Operations?

The 22/7 settlement windows are as follows:

Settlement Window	Time
Before Normal Business Hours	12:00 AM to 8:59 AM
Normal Business Hours	9:00 AM to 7:00 PM
After Normal Business Hours	7:01 PM to 10:00 PM

There will be a 2-hour window from 10:01 PM to 11:59 PM for housekeeping.

6. What is the RTGS business date convention?

Transactions settled between 12:00 AM to 10:00 PM will be value-dated on the same business day. However, transactions made on Saturday and Sunday will be value-dated Monday.

C. SENDING AND RECEIVING TRANSACTIONS

7. Are participants required to operate 22/7?

Sending transactions during extended operating hours will be optional. However, participants are expected to maintain the capability to receive transactions and comply with applicable regulatory requirements.

8. Can a receiving institution defer the crediting of funds until the next business day?

For InstaPay transactions, beneficiary accounts shall be immediately credited under the 'clear before settle' arrangement.

For PESONet transactions, receiving institutions shall credit the beneficiary accounts within the BSP-prescribed turnaround time for crediting such accounts.

For customer payments made directly through the *PhilPaSS^{plus}* (pacs.008), the BSP expects the participants to credit the beneficiaries' accounts at the soonest possible time, consistent with the purpose of the *PhilPaSS^{plus}* as a facility for real-time funds transfers.

D. LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

9. Will BSP extend the operating hours of its monetary operations?

No.

10. Can participants access the Overnight Liquidity Facility (OLF) after normal business hours?

No.

11. Will participants be allowed to fund their Secured Settlement Accounts (SSAs) before or after normal business hours?

Yes.

12. What will be the Peso RTGS settlement facilities for extended hours of operations?

The existing Intraday Settlement Facility (ISF) with Extended ISF shall be enhanced to support the liquidity requirements of participants under the 22/7 Peso RTGS Operations.

The ISF shall retain its Automatic Availment feature and shall be enhanced to include the following:

- Recurring intraday collateral for multi-day use;
- An advance ISF repurchase option;
- Extended operating hours from 9:00 AM to 9:30 PM; and
- Conversion to Extended ISF shall take place at 9:46 PM.

E. QUEUING AND TRANSACTION REJECTIONS

13. Will queuing functionality remain available 22/7?

Yes.

14. What happens if a participant has insufficient funds during extended operating hours?

Participants are expected to actively manage their liquidity positions and funding requirements. If funds are insufficient, transactions may remain in the queue pending the availability of funds. Queued transactions will be settled once sufficient liquidity becomes available.

15. Will penalties be imposed for rejected, cancelled, or queued transactions during extended operating hours?

No penalty will be imposed on rejected or cancelled transactions and those that are in the queue beyond 15 minutes between 12:00 AM to 8:59 AM (*Before Normal Business Hours*). From 9:00 AM to 10:00 PM (*Normal Business Hours to After Normal Business Hours*), applicable penalties will continue to be imposed considering that the free-of-charge settlement facility is available during this period.

F. RESERVE REQUIREMENT COMPLIANCE

16. How will the reserve requirements be implemented under extended operating hours?

The manner of determining compliance will generally be the same, following Section 254 of the Manual of Regulations for Banks (MORB) and BSP Memorandum No. M-2025-028 dated 12 August 2025 in lieu of Appendix 88 of this Manual.

17. What Demand Deposit Account (DDA) balance will be used for reserve requirement compliance?

The DDA balance as of 10:00 PM will be used in determining reserve requirement compliance.

18. Will transactions settled after the end of Normal Business Hours at 7:00 PM affect reserve balances?

Yes. Transactions settled up to 10:00 PM cut-off will form part of the DDA balance used in determining reserve requirement compliance.

G. RETAIL PAYMENT SYSTEMS

19. Will PESONet become a real-time payment system under 22/7 operations?

No. PESONet will remain a batch retail payment system.

20. Will BSP introduce additional settlement cycles for PESONet and InstaPay?

The BSP may introduce additional settlement cycles in collaboration with the industry.

H. CHECKS AND FINANCIAL MARKET TRANSACTIONS

21. What is BSP's expectation regarding returned checks?

The BSP expects the industry to move toward same-day settlement of returned checks before the 10:00 PM RTGS cut-off instead of 9:00 AM on T+1.

22. Will there be changes to DvP, eDvP, and PvP settlement windows?

The BSP welcomes the potential extension of settlement windows for financial market transactions, subject to market demand, operational readiness, and the applicable arrangements between the BSP and the relevant financial market infrastructures.

23. Will participants still need to request extensions of RTGS operating hours for transactions they will settle after the Normal Business Hours ending at 7:00 PM?

No.

I. CROSS-BORDER PAYMENTS

24. Why is 22/7 important for cross-border payments?

Extended RTGS operating hours will allow the country to achieve more synchronized settlement windows with major international markets, enabling faster settlement and crediting of cross-border payment transactions, including remittances.

J. 24/7 HELPDESK SUPPORT

25. Will BSP provide customer service during extended operating hours?

Yes.

26. Where may participants direct questions regarding the 22/7 Peso RTGS Operations Project?

Participants may coordinate with the BSP Payments and Settlements Department (PSD) via email at rtgs@bsp.gov.ph or through the following numbers: 8400-7024, 8400-7071, 8400-7073, 8708-7540, 8708-7694 and 8708-7697.

K. BILLING CYCLES

27. Will there be changes in the billing cycle?

Multiple billing cycles may run on a single business day to make reconciliation easier for *PhilPaSS^{plus}* participants.